State Machines and the LCD Display

Module	ET4047
Date	28/10/2026
Lab No.	Lab 6
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1 Task 1: A traffic light on the LCD

Objective: run a three-state traffic light (RED → GREEN → YELLOW) and change the state machine.

Wiring

I2C LCD connections (used in every task)

From		To	Purpose
LCD **GND**	→	Nano **GND**	Ground
LCD **VCC**	→	Nano **5V**	Power
LCD **SDA**	→	Nano **A4**	I2C data
LCD **SCL**	→	Nano **A5**	I2C clock

LCD wiring (every task)

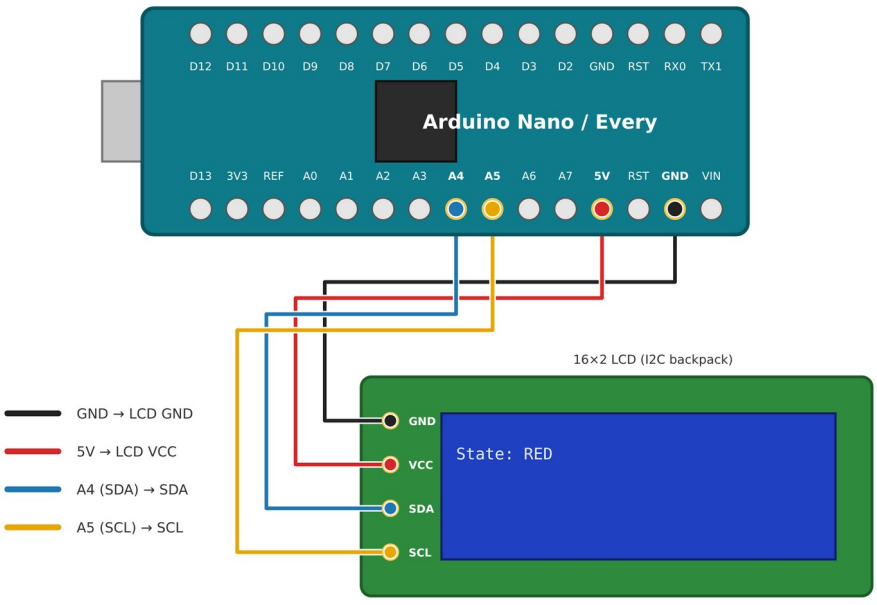


Figure 1: LCD wiring. The RGB LCD shield needs no wires: plug it onto the breakout board.

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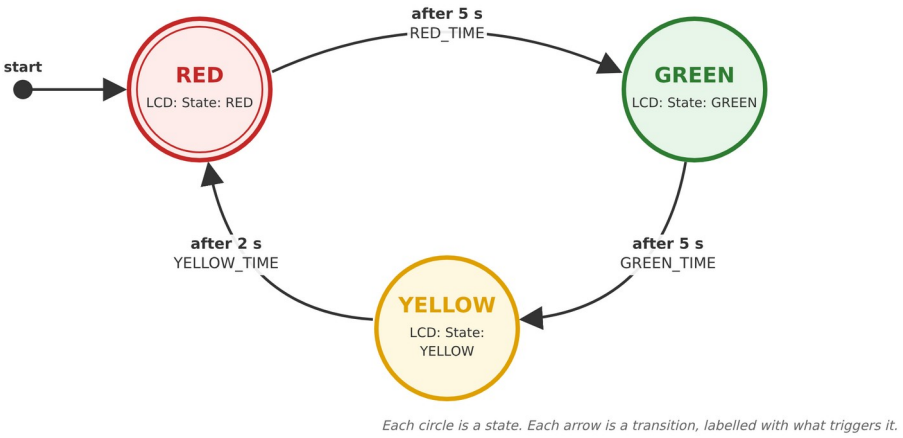


Figure 2: Task 1 state diagram

> **Code**
>
> Upload `Task1_Traffic_Light`. Use the folder for your display: `I2C_Backpack_LCD` (separate screen with four wires) or `Adafruit_RGB_LCD_Shield` (plugs on, five buttons).

Expected result: the LCD shows `State: RED` for 5 s, `State: GREEN` for 5 s, `State: YELLOW` for 2 s, and repeats.

Task 1 questions

1a Run it

Upload the code and check the states change in the right order. **(record)** Take a photo of the LCD.

1b The transition table

Fill in the table from the code.

Current state	Time in state	Next state	LCD shows
RED			
GREEN			
YELLOW			

How long does one full cycle take?

Your answer:

1c Change the timing

Make YELLOW last 3 seconds instead of 2. Which line did you change? Why is it better to keep the times in named constants such as `YELLOW_TIME` than to type `delay(2000)` inside the case?

Your answer:

1d Add a state

Add a fourth state, `RED_AMBER`, which shows `State: RED+AMBER` for 2 s, so the cycle becomes RED → RED_AMBER → GREEN → YELLOW → RED. Which three places in the code did you change? **(record)** Draw your new state diagram.

Your answer:

2 Task 2: Traffic light with real LEDs

Objective: drive a red, a yellow and a green LED from the state machine, with exactly one LED on at a time.

Wiring

LED connections (keep the LCD wiring from Task 1)

From		To	Purpose
Nano **D5**	→	220 Ω → **red** LED long leg	Red light
Nano **D6**	→	220 Ω → **yellow** LED long leg	Yellow light
Nano **D7**	→	220 Ω → **green** LED long leg	Green light
Each LED short leg	→	GND rail → Nano **GND**	Common ground

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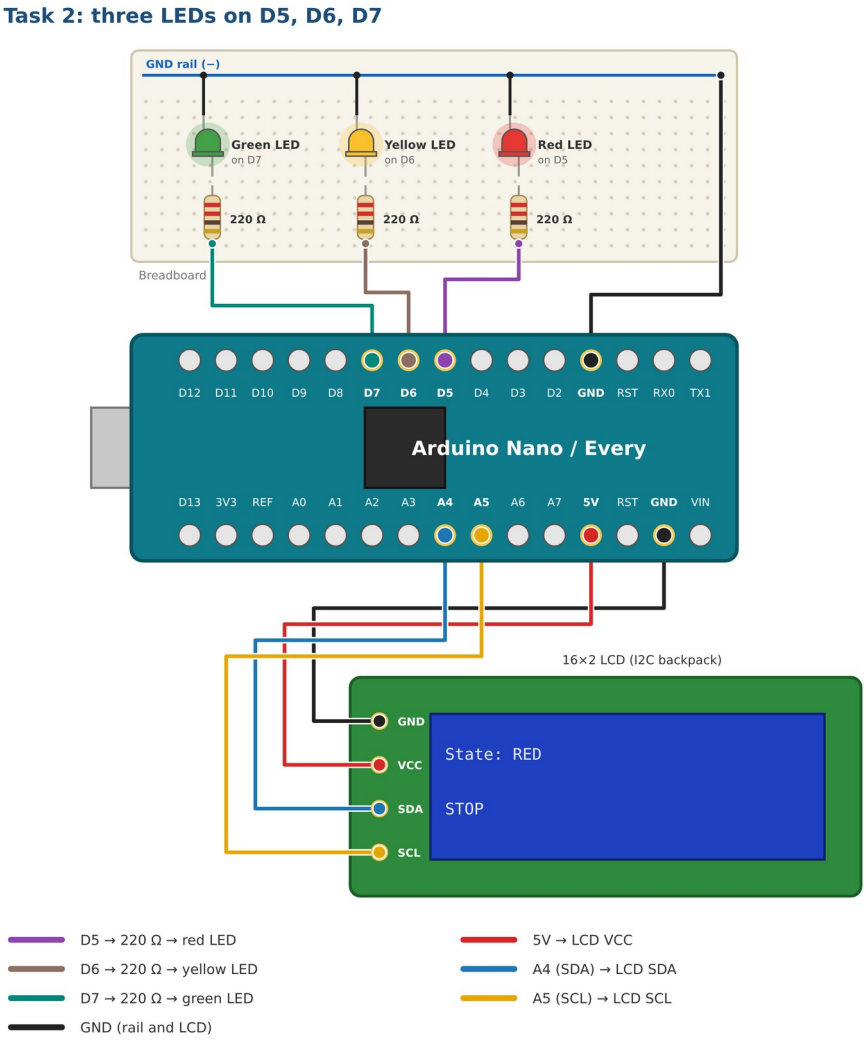


Figure 3: Task 2 wiring

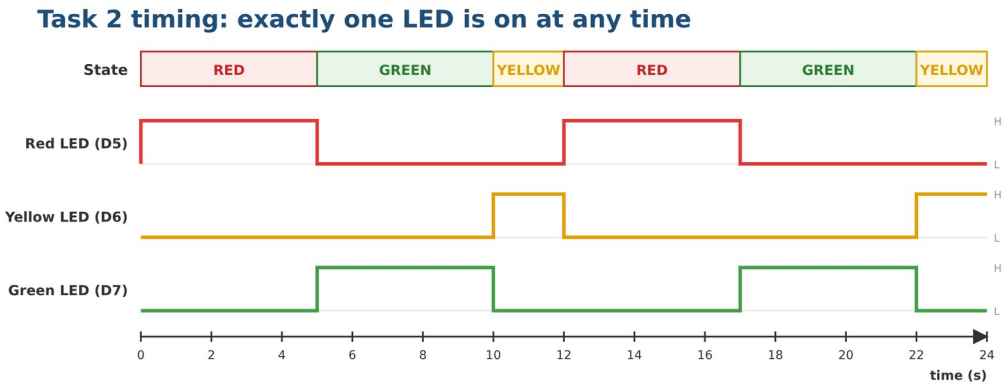


Figure 4: Task 2 LED outputs over two cycles

Code

Upload `Task2_Traffic_Light_LEDs`. Use the folder for your display: `I2C_Backpack_LCD` (separate screen with four wires) or `Adafruit_RGB_LCD_Shield` (plugs on, five buttons).

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Expected result: one LED at a time, in step with the LCD (`State: RED` / `STOP`, and so on).

Task 2 questions

2a Run it

(record) Paste a few lines from the Serial Monitor. They should look like this:

Serial Monitor

```
Traffic light ready
State 0: RED
State 1: GREEN
State 2: YELLOW
```

2b Forget to switch an LED off

In each case, replace the `setLights(…)` line with a single `digitalWrite(…, HIGH)` for that state's LED. Run it for two cycles. What do the LEDs show, and why? Compare with Figure 4. Then put `setLights()` back.

Your answer:

2c The numbers behind the names

What would the LCD show if you changed the enum to `{ RED, YELLOW, GREEN }` but left the two text arrays as they are? Why?

Your answer:

2d The resistor

A red LED drops about 2 V and the pin gives 5 V. Roughly how much current flows through the 220 Ω resistor?

Your answer:

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3 Task 3: A pedestrian crossing

Objective: the cars' light stays GREEN until the button is pressed, then goes YELLOW → WALK (countdown) → CLEAR → GREEN. The sketch uses `millis()` instead of `delay()`.

Wiring

Add the button (keep the LEDs and LCD from Task 2)

From		To	Purpose
Nano **D2**	→	Push button, one leg	Pedestrian button
Push button, other leg	→	GND rail	Pressing pulls D2 to 0 V

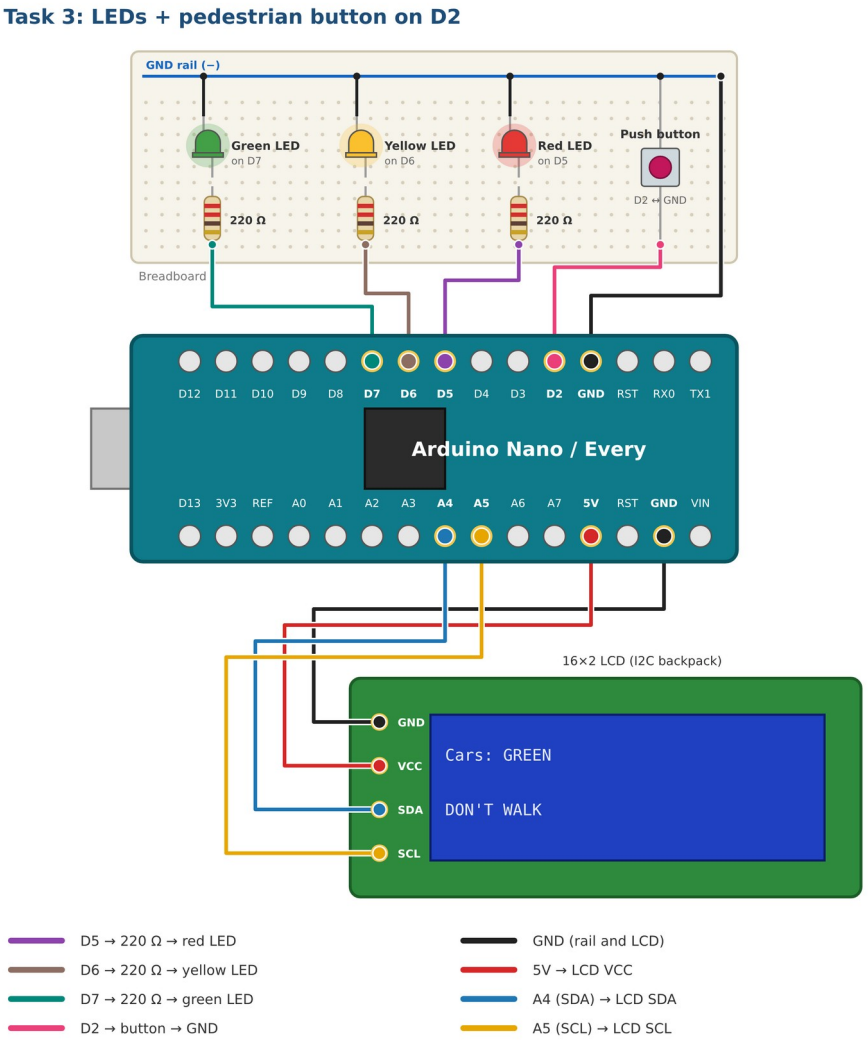


Figure 5: Task 3 wiring

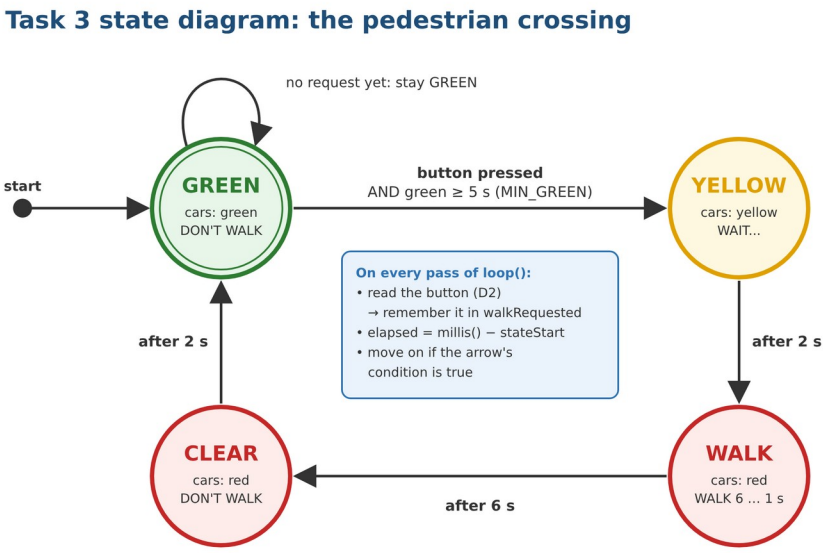


Figure 6: Task 3 state diagram

> **Code**
>
> Upload `Task3_Pedestrian_Crossing`. Use the folder for your display: `I2C_Backpack_LCD` (separate screen with four wires) or `Adafruit_RGB_LCD_Shield` (plugs on, five buttons).

Expected result: the light stays GREEN until you press the button; the LCD shows `WAIT...`, then a `WALK 6s ... 1s` countdown.

Task 3 questions

3a Run it

Press the button. **(record)** Paste the Serial Monitor output for one crossing. It should look like this:

Serial Monitor

```
Crossing ready
-> GREEN
Button pressed
-> YELLOW
-> WALK
-> CLEAR
-> GREEN
```

3b Press it at different times

Press the button at each of the times below. Use the state diagram to explain each result.

When you press	What happens	Why
Just after the light turns GREEN		
When GREEN has been on for more than 5 s		
During WALK		

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When you press	What happens	Why
During CLEAR		

3c delay() would miss it

If Task 2 checked the button at the top of `loop()`, what is the longest a pedestrian might have to hold it before the board noticed? Why does Task 3 notice a tap of a few milliseconds?

Your answer:

3d No debouncing needed

One press of a mechanical button can read as several quick presses. Why does that not cause a problem here? (Hint: what does a second press do to `walkRequested`?)

Your answer:

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